

Bangladesh National ICT Policy 2018:

Key Aspects

The Bangladesh National ICT Policy 2018 was formulated to transform the country into a knowledge-based society and achieve the goals of "Digital Bangladesh" by 2021 and "Vision 2041". It is structured around 8 broad objectives, 55 strategic themes, and over 300 action items.

Core Objectives

The policy focuses on eight primary strategic pillars designed to drive socio-economic transformation:

Digital Government: Aiming for 100% online government services to ensure transparency, accountability, and accessibility at the citizen's doorstep.

Digital Security: Establishing a secure digital ecosystem through frameworks like the Digital Security Act 2018 and institutions like the national CERT (Computer Emergency Response Team).

Social Equity and Universal Access: Reducing the digital divide by ensuring affordable internet and ICT access for all, including rural populations and persons with disabilities.

Education, Research, and Innovation: Integrating ICT into all levels of education, updating curricula for the 4th Industrial Revolution, and supporting tech startups through innovation funds.

Skill Development and Employment: Training 2 million youth in IT/freelancing and enhancing the workforce to meet domestic and global market demands.

Strengthening Domestic Capacity: Promoting local ICT industries, software technology parks, and providing tax incentives for local hardware and software entrepreneurs.

Environment, Climate, and Disaster Management: Utilizing "Green ICT" for environmental protection, disaster warning systems, and safe e-waste management.

Enhancing Productivity: Maximizing ICT use to increase efficiency in key sectors like agriculture, health, commerce, and finance.

Strategic Pillars & Key Targets

Economic Goals: The policy aimed to reach \$5 billion in ICT export revenue and create 2 million jobs in the sector by 2021.

Infrastructure: Focused on expanding high-speed broadband to rural areas, establishing Tier-3 and Tier-4 Data Centers, and preparing for 5G and IoT.

Citizen-Centric Services: Decentralizing development through Union Digital Centers (UDCs) to provide local e-services to rural citizens.

Implementation and Ownership

Lead Agency: The ICT Division under the Ministry of Posts, Telecommunications and Information Technology is the primary body for monitoring and coordination.

Phased Approach: Action items are categorized into short-term (18 months), medium-term (5 years), and long-term (10 years) goals.

Governance: The National ICT Task Force, headed by the Prime Minister, oversees the policy's high-level implementation.